

WEST ASIA, ENERGY SECURITY AND CONNECTIVITY

CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE → TWO VARIABLES ANSWERS KEEP → ENERGY TRILEMMA AS THE → ISRAEL TRACK: DEPTH ACROSS → GULF ARCHITECTURE WITH DATES → TRADE INSTRUMENTS AND THEIR

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE THREE PARALLEL TRACKS

CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE THREE PARALLEL TRACKS HOW DOES ONE REGION CARRY ENERGY, PEOPLE AND CORRIDORS ROOT CONDITION CRUDE-OIL IMPORT DEPENDENCE OF 88.2% IN FY2024-25 ABOUT 88.7% PROVISIONAL IN FY2025-26; SIKRI'S BOOK PERIOD APPROXIMATELY 70% TRACK 1 GULF AND ARAB WORLD

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL QUESTION → how does one region carry energy, people and corridors at once?
- ROOT CONDITION → crude-oil import dependence of 88.2% in FY2024-25
- about 88.7% provisional in FY2025-26; Sikri's book period: approximately 70%

MECHANISM

- TRACK 1 → GULF and ARAB WORLD: energy and diaspora
- TRACK 2 → ISRAEL: technology, defence, agriculture, innovation
- TRACK 3 → IRAN: energy history and Chabahar connectivity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DOCTRINE → Look West, named by Tharoor as a parallel to Look East
- RULE → parallel and non-exclusive tracks, never a sequence of choices
- MUST REMEMBER: West Asia policy balances energy security, diaspora welfare, remittances,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → parallel and non-exclusive tracks, never a sequence of choices.

01

STAGE 01 TWO VARIABLES ANSWERS KEEP MERGING

TWO VARIABLES ANSWERS KEEP MERGING WIDENING THE SET OF SUPPLIERS AND EQUITY SOURCES US SHARE 4.6% 8.1%; UAE SHARE 9.4% 11.1%, APRIL-NOVEMBER FY26 ALSO ROSE EGYPT, NIGERIA, LIBYA RUSSIA, SAUDI ARABIA, IRAQ, VENEZUELA

CORE CLAIM

DIVERSIFICATION → widening the set of suppliers and equity sources
EVIDENCE: US share 4.6% → 8.1%; UAE share 9.4% → 11.1%, April-November FY26
ALSO ROSE: Egypt, Nigeria, Libya

MECHANISM

DECLINED: Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Venezuela
DEPENDENCE REDUCTION → lowering the share of consumption that must be imported
EVIDENCE: aggregate dependence remained very high across the same period

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

VERDICT → diversification of sources, expressly not reduction of dependence
BRAKE → refineries devised for the quality of crude that Iran supplies

CORE CLAIM

- DIVERSIFICATION → widening the set of suppliers and equity sources
- EVIDENCE: US share 4.6% → 8.1%; UAE share 9.4% → 11.1%, April-November FY26
- ALSO ROSE: Egypt, Nigeria, Libya

MECHANISM

- DECLINED: Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Venezuela
- DEPENDENCE REDUCTION → lowering the share of consumption that must be imported
- EVIDENCE: aggregate dependence remained very high across the same period

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → diversification of sources, expressly not reduction of dependence
- BRAKE → refineries devised for the quality of crude that Iran supplies

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → diversification of sources, expressly not reduction of dependence.

02

STAGE 02 ENERGY TRILEMMA AS THE EVALUATIVE FRAME

ENERGY TRILEMMA AS THE EVALUATIVE FRAME SUSTAINABILITY SUPPLY PRICE EXPOSURE AND TRANSITION PRESSURE AND RELIABILITY IMPORT-BILL BURDEN LONG-HORIZON SUBSTITUTION A SECURITY-ONLY FRAME HIDES TRADE-OFFS BETWEEN THESE THREE LIMBS DIVERSIFICATION SERVES SECURITY; IT DOES NOT SETTLE AFFORDABILITY

CORE CLAIM

SUSTAINABILITY supply
price exposure and
transition pressure and reliability

MECHANISM

import-bill burden
long-horizon substitution
TENSION → a security-only frame hides trade-offs between these three limbs

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

APPLIED → diversification serves security; it does not settle affordability
APPLIED → transition pressure reshapes what security will mean over time
RULE → evaluate the portfolio on all three axes, not on supply alone

CORE CLAIM

- SUSTAINABILITY supply
- price exposure and
- transition pressure and reliability

MECHANISM

- import-bill burden
- long-horizon substitution
- TENSION → a security-only frame hides trade-offs between these three limbs

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- APPLIED → diversification serves security; it does not settle affordability
- APPLIED → transition pressure reshapes what security will mean over time
- RULE → evaluate the portfolio on all three axes, not on supply alone

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → evaluate the portfolio on all three axes, not on supply alone.

03

STAGE 03 ISRAEL TRACK: DEPTH ACROSS DISTINCT DOMAINS

ISRAEL TRACK DEPTH ACROSS DISTINCT DOMAINS FULL DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS ESTABLISHED JULY 2017 FIRST VISIT BY AN INDIAN PRIME MINISTER TO ISRAEL PROCUREMENT, COUNTER-TERRORISM, CO-DEVELOPMENT; BARAK-8 INDO-ISRAEL AGRICULTURAL PROJECT CENTRES OF EXCELLENCE

INDIA-OMAN CEPA → SIGNED on 18 December 2025 entry into force requires separate verification

IR KEEPS → the strategic-partnership significance of each instrument

INDIA-UAE CEPA → IN FORCE since 1 May 2022 reported bilateral trade approximately USD 100 billion in FY2024-25

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political declaration, memorandum, treaty, investment pledge, corridor.

06

STAGE 06CORRIDOR DIPLOMACY AGAINST CORRIDOR INFRASTRUCTURE

CORRIDOR DIPLOMACY AGAINST CORRIDOR INFRASTRUCTURE

9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI

IMEC MEMORANDUM SIGNED BY EIGHT PARTIES

INDIA, US, SAUDI ARABIA, UAE, EU, FRANCE, GERMANY, ITALY

24 JUNE 2024

MEA INDIA-UAE READOUT REFERS TO COMMENCEMENT OF WORK

NO COMPLETED CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATING SEGMENT OFFICIALLY ESTABLISHED

CONNECTIVITY DIPLOMACY CREATES MOMENTUM, NOT DELIVERED INFRASTRUCTURE

9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI → IMEC memorandum signed by eight parties

India, US, Saudi Arabia, UAE, EU, France, Germany, Italy

24 JUNE 2024: MEA India-UAE readout refers to commencement of work

STATUS: no completed construction or operating segment officially established

CONSEQUENCE → connectivity diplomacy creates momentum, not delivered infrastructure

CORE CLAIM

• 9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI → IMEC memorandum signed by eight parties

• India, US, Saudi Arabia, UAE, EU, France, Germany, Italy

MECHANISM

• 24 JUNE 2024: MEA India-UAE readout refers to commencement of work

• STATUS: no completed construction or operating segment officially established

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• CONSEQUENCE → connectivity diplomacy creates momentum, not delivered infrastructure

• STRESS TEST → regional conflict raises political, security and route-risk costs

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STRESS TEST → regional conflict raises political, security and route-risk costs.

07

STAGE 07IRAN TRACK: INSTRUMENT, WITHDRAWAL AND DISPUTED STATUS

IRAN TRACK

INSTRUMENT, WITHDRAWAL AND DISPUTED STATUS

14 JULY 2015

JOINT COMPREHENSIVE PLAN OF ACTION CONCLUDED, IRAN WITH E3/EU+3

ENDORSED BY UN SECURITY COUNCIL RESOLUTION 2231

8 MAY 2018

UNITED STATES ANNOUNCES WITHDRAWAL; SANCTIONS RESTORED IN STAGES

MAY 2019

14 JULY 2015 → Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded, Iran with E3/EU+3

endorsed by UN Security Council resolution 2231

8 MAY 2018 → United States announces withdrawal; sanctions restored in stages

MAY 2019 → Significant Reduction Exceptions end; India ceases Iranian crude purchases

13 MAY 2024 → ten-year Chabahar contract signed

CORE CLAIM

• 14 JULY 2015 → Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded, Iran with E3/EU+3

• endorsed by UN Security Council resolution 2231

• 8 MAY 2018 → United States announces withdrawal; sanctions restored in stages

MECHANISM

• MAY 2019 → Significant Reduction Exceptions end; India ceases Iranian crude purchases

• 13 MAY 2024 → ten-year Chabahar contract signed

• 29 SEPTEMBER 2025 → the 2018 Chabahar exception revoked with effect from this date

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• 2025 → after the E3 snapback action the status of restored UN measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China

• do not call the Plan normally functioning

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2025 → after the E3 snapback action the status of restored UN measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; do not call the Plan normally functioning.

08

STAGE 08COMPOUNDING RISK AT ONE CHOKEPOINT

COMPOUNDING RISK AT ONE CHOKEPOINT

STRAIT OF HORMUZ

NARROW OUTLET FROM THE PERSIAN GULF TO THE GULF

FREIGHT, INSURANCE AND SUPPLY INSECURITY TRANSMIT IMMEDIATELY

PHYSICAL SAFETY OF A VERY LARGE EXPATRIATE POPULATION IS

CORRIDOR AND PROJECT VIABILITY IS EXPOSED AT THE SAME

DIVERSIFICATION DOES NOT REMOVE COMMON-ROUTE EXPOSURE

RESERVES AND ALTERNATIVE ENERGY REDUCE BUT DO NOT REMOVE

STRAIT OF HORMUZ → narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman

ENERGY: freight, insurance and supply insecurity transmit immediately

DIASPORA: physical safety of a very large expatriate population is exposed

CONNECTIVITY: corridor and project viability is exposed at the same moment

LIMIT → diversification does not remove common-route exposure

CORE CLAIM

• STRAIT OF HORMUZ → narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman

• ENERGY: freight, insurance and supply insecurity transmit immediately

• DIASPORA: physical safety of a very large expatriate population is exposed

MECHANISM

• CONNECTIVITY: corridor and project viability is exposed at the same moment

• LIMIT → diversification does not remove common-route exposure

• LIMIT → reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• DISTINCTIVE → compounding rather than isolated risk, unlike most partner regions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISTINCTIVE → compounding rather than isolated risk, unlike most partner regions.

09

STAGE 09DIASPORA EXPOSURE PRICED WITH DATED EVIDENCE

DIASPORA EXPOSURE PRICED WITH DATED EVIDENCE

A DIASPORA OF 5 MILLION IN THE GULF, PERIOD-SPECIFIC

THE ARAB WORLD IS HOME TO NEARLY 6 MILLION

MEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026

UAE 4,344,008

SAUDI ARABIA 2,750,551

POPULATION-STOCK ESTIMATES, NOT CITIZENSHIP OR OCI COUNTS

27 JUNE 2025

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SIKRI → a diaspora of 5 million in the Gulf, period-specific	Saudi Arabia 2,750,551	3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel
THAROOR → the Arab world is home to nearly 6 million Indians, period-specific	STATUS → population-stock estimates, not citizenship or OCI counts	BOUNDARY → relief logistics to Disaster Management; consular diplomacy here and topic 09

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09

STAGE 09 DIASPORA EXPOSURE PRICED WITH DATED EVIDENCE

DIASPORA EXPOSURE PRICED WITH DATED EVIDENCE A DIASPORA OF 5 MILLION IN THE GULF, PERIOD-SPECIFIC THE ARAB WORLD IS HOME TO NEARLY 6 MILLION MEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026 UAE 4,344,008 SAUDI ARABIA 2,750,551 POPULATION-STOCK ESTIMATES, NOT CITIZENSHIP OR OCI COUNTS

27 JUNE 2025

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SIKRI → a diaspora of 5 million in the Gulf, period-specific	Saudi Arabia 2,750,551	3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel
THAROOR → the Arab world is home to nearly 6 million Indians, period-specific	STATUS → population-stock estimates, not citizenship or OCI counts	BOUNDARY → relief logistics to Disaster Management; consular diplomacy here and topic 09
MEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026 → UAE 4,344,008	27 JUNE 2025 → Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 nationals	

CORE CLAIM

- SIKRI → a diaspora of 5 million in the Gulf, period-specific
- THAROOR → the Arab world is home to nearly 6 million Indians, period-specific
- MEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026 → UAE 4,344,008

MECHANISM

- Saudi Arabia 2,750,551
- STATUS → population-stock estimates, not citizenship or OCI counts
- 27 JUNE 2025 → Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 nationals

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel
- BOUNDARY → relief logistics to Disaster Management; consular diplomacy here and topic 09

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → relief logistics to Disaster Management; consular diplomacy here and topic 09.

10

STAGE 10 BALANCING WITHOUT CONTRADICTION

BALANCING WITHOUT CONTRADICTION DEEPENING ISRAEL TIES COULD BE READ AS A SLIGHT INDIA VALUES ISRAEL TIES BUT NOT AT THE EXPENSE A TWO-STATE POSITION COULD BE READ AS ABANDONING ISRAEL RECOGNITION OF THE STATE OF PALESTINE IN 1988 RUNS

THE OCTOBER 2023 CONFLICT TESTS BOTH LIMBS AT ONCE CONDEMN TERRORISM, SEEK HUMANITARIAN PROTECTION, HOSTAGE RELEASE, DIALOGUE ACTIVE BALANCING SUSTAINED BY CONTINUOUS EFFORT, NOT A SINGLE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• PROBLEM → deepening Israel ties could be read as a slight by Arab partners	• RESPONSE: recognition of the State of Palestine in 1988 runs alongside full relations	• VERDICT → active balancing sustained by continuous effort, not a single declaration
• RESPONSE: India values Israel ties but not at the expense of Arab and Muslim friendships	• PROBLEM → the October 2023 conflict tests both limbs at once	
• PROBLEM → a two-state position could be read as abandoning Israel cooperation	• RESPONSE: condemn terrorism, seek humanitarian protection, hostage release, dialogue	

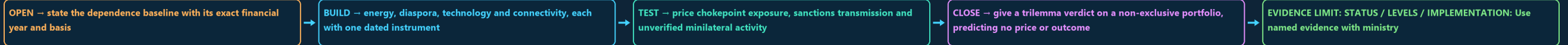
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → active balancing sustained by continuous effort, not a single declaration.

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER SPINE FOR A WEST ASIA DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A WEST ASIA DEMAND STATE THE DEPENDENCE BASELINE WITH ITS EXACT FINANCIAL YEAR ENERGY, DIASPORA, TECHNOLOGY AND CONNECTIVITY, EACH WITH ONE DATED PRICE CHOKEPOINT EXPOSURE, SANCTIONS TRANSMISSION AND UNVERIFIED MINILATERAL ACTIVITY

GIVE A TRILEMMA VERDICT ON A NON-EXCLUSIVE PORTFOLIO, PREDICTING EVIDENCE LIMIT USE NAMED EVIDENCE WITH MINISTRY



CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• OPEN → state the dependence baseline with its exact financial year and basis	• TEST → price chokepoint exposure, sanctions transmission and unverified minilateral activity	• EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Use named evidence with ministry....
• BUILD → energy, diaspora, technology and connectivity, each with one dated instrument	• CLOSE → give a trilemma verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio, predicting no price or outcome	• OPEN → state the dependence baseline with its exact financial year and basis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → give a trilemma verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio, predicting no price or outcome.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT INDIA-GCC JOINT ACTION PLAN (2024-2028) ADOPTED AT THE FIRST INDIA-GCC BILATERAL STRATEGIC ARCHITECTURE THE INDIA-SAUDI STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP UAE-INDIA CEPA (IN FORCE 1 MAY 2022) A BILATERAL TRADE-AGREEMENT I2U2 (INDIA-ISRAEL-UAE-US)

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- India-GCC Joint Action Plan (2024-2028): adopted at the first India-GCC
- Bilateral strategic architecture: the India-Saudi Strategic Partnership
- CAUTION: UAE-India CEPA (in force 1 May 2022): a bilateral trade-agreement
- CAUTION: I2U2 (India-Israel-UAE-US): a minilateral framework on food security,

ADVANCED DEBATE

- IMEC/IMEEC: an eight-party MoU signed on 9 September 2023 (India, US,
- Chabahar port (Iran): 10-year contract signed 13 May 2024; US sanctions
- Direct PYQ boundary case (2025 Q19): the question's framing — energy
- CAUTION: Boundary case — Iran under sanctions pressure: Tharoor notes "Iran's

LEGACY / NUANCE

- CAUTION: Boundary case — Israel-Palestine escalation risk: any escalation
- CAUTION: Boundary case — diaspora welfare during regional conflict: any Gulf/
- CAUTION: Diversification manages risk but does not eliminate dependence: equity
- CAUTION: Triangular balancing requires continuous diplomatic management: the

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.